

REMODELING COST GUIDE

The Atlas remodeling cost guide

What it actually costs to remodel a home in Eastern Pennsylvania.

WELCOME

Why we wrote this guide

Most remodeling cost articles you find online are written for a national audience. They average together prices from California to Kentucky and produce a number that does not mean much in Bucks County. They also tend to lowball the cost of doing the work well, which sets homeowners up for sticker shock when they get real proposals.

We wrote this guide because our clients deserve better. The ranges in here reflect current material and labor costs for homeowners in Bucks County, Montgomery County and the Lehigh Valley. They cover the four services we offer: **custom bathrooms, custom kitchens, basement remodeling and whole home renovations.**

This is not a price list. Every remodel is different. The scope, the finishes, the condition of the existing home and the layout decisions all move the number. What this guide will do is help you understand the range, what drives it and how to budget for the project you are planning.

If you have questions after reading it, we are happy to walk through your specific project with you.

John and the Atlas team

Owner operated · Eastern Pennsylvania

THE FUNDAMENTALS

How remodeling costs actually work

Three things drive the final number on any remodel.

01

Scope

Are we keeping the existing layout or moving walls. Are we replacing fixtures and finishes in place or relocating plumbing and electrical. Are we doing one room or a connected sequence of rooms. The bigger the scope, the bigger the number.

02

Finish level

Stock cabinetry and quartz finish one project. Custom cabinetry, stone slabs, custom metal or glass, integrated lighting and high end appliances finish another. The same kitchen footprint can vary by a factor of three depending on finish choices.

03

Site conditions

Older homes in Bucks County often hide knob and tube wiring, lath and plaster walls, outdated plumbing or settling foundations. These are not flaws, they are part of what makes older homes special. They do, however, add to the cost when a remodel uncovers them.

Why we publish ranges, not fixed numbers

Until we walk through a home, see the existing conditions and understand the scope, any specific number would be a guess. The ranges in this guide are honest reflections of what comparable projects have cost.



SERVICE 01

Custom bathroom remodeling

TYPICAL INVESTMENT RANGES IN OUR SERVICE AREA

Half or guest bathroom	$25,000 – $50,000
Primary bathroom, layout unchanged	$55,000 – $75,000
Primary or owner's bathroom	$75,000 – $120,000
Primary suite with custom features	$120,000+

These ranges reflect current material and labor costs across Bucks County, Montgomery County and the Lehigh Valley.

WHAT PUSHES TOWARD THE HIGH END

- Moving plumbing or relocating the toilet, tub or shower
- Custom vanities and built in storage
- Stone slab counters and full height stone walls
- Frameless glass enclosures
- Heated floors and towel warmers
- Steam showers, soaking tubs or wet rooms
- Custom metal or glass details (an Atlas specialty)
- Structural reframing for larger showers or windows

WHAT KEEPS IT IN THE LOWER RANGE

- Keeping the existing layout
- Stock or semi-custom vanities
- Tile counters or quartz instead of stone slab
- Standard fixture and fitting selections
- No structural or plumbing relocation

A note on timelines

Bathrooms typically run 4 to 8 weeks from demo to final walkthrough. Selection lead times can extend the planning phase by several weeks. We do not give exact completion dates until the scope and selections are locked.



SERVICE 02

Custom kitchen remodeling

TYPICAL INVESTMENT RANGES IN OUR SERVICE AREA

Cosmetic kitchen update, existing cabinets painted or refaced	$35,000 – $55,000
Kitchen refresh, layout unchanged	$55,000 – $110,000
Kitchen remodel, partial layout changes	$110,000 – $185,000
Custom kitchen, structural or layout changes	$185,000 – $325,000
Kitchen plus connected living or dining	$325,000+

These ranges reflect current material and labor costs across Bucks County, Montgomery County and the Lehigh Valley.

WHAT PUSHES TOWARD THE HIGH END

- Removing or relocating walls to open the space
- Custom cabinetry built to fit the home
- Stone slab counters and full height stone backsplashes
- High end appliance packages (Wolf, Sub-Zero, La Cornue)
- Custom metal range hoods and glass cabinet inserts
- Hardwood flooring continued into adjoining rooms
- Structural beams or post relocations

WHAT KEEPS IT IN THE LOWER RANGE

- Keeping the existing layout
- Semi-custom cabinetry from a quality line
- Quartz counters and tile backsplash
- Mid range appliance package
- Refinishing existing floors instead of replacing

Where Atlas tends to add the most value

Kitchens with design forward elements, custom built ins, layout reconfiguration and integration with adjoining living spaces. This is where craftsmanship and thoughtful design show up most clearly in the finished result.



SERVICE 03

Basement remodeling and finishing

TYPICAL INVESTMENT RANGES IN OUR SERVICE AREA

Basic finished basement, open living space	$45,000 – $80,000
Finished basement with bedroom or office	$80,000 – $130,000
Full lower level with bathroom and wet bar	$125,000 – $200,000
Custom lower level, multiple finished rooms	$200,000+

These ranges reflect current material and labor costs across Bucks County, Montgomery County and the Lehigh Valley.

WHAT PUSHES TOWARD THE HIGH END

- Adding a full bathroom or wet bar
- Custom built ins, including media walls and bookcases
- Egress windows or daylight window enlargement
- Waterproofing or moisture remediation found in demo
- Engineered flooring instead of carpet
- Custom lighting plans
- Sound dampening for home theater or music spaces

WHAT KEEPS IT IN THE LOWER RANGE

- Open living space only, no plumbing
- Drywall and trim with carpet
- Recessed lighting on a simple plan
- No structural changes

A note on older basements in our area

Many homes in our service area have lower ceiling heights, older block or stone foundations and moisture history. These can be addressed, but they affect both the timeline and the budget. We assess this on site before committing to a number.



SERVICE 04

Whole home remodeling

TYPICAL INVESTMENT RANGES IN OUR SERVICE AREA

Cosmetic refresh across multiple rooms	$250,000 – $350,000
Multi room remodel, selective layout changes	$350,000 – $500,000
Whole home renovation with structural changes	$500,000 – $750,000
Whole home with addition or expansion	$750,000+

These ranges reflect current material and labor costs across Bucks County, Montgomery County and the Lehigh Valley.

WHAT PUSHES TOWARD THE HIGH END

- Structural changes, removing load bearing walls or relocating staircases
- Additions, dormers or expanded footprints
- Custom cabinetry and millwork throughout
- High end finishes across every room
- Mechanical, electrical and plumbing upgrades for older systems
- Custom metal, glass and architectural detail work

WHAT KEEPS IT IN THE LOWER RANGE

- Cosmetic work only, no layout or structural changes
- Mid range finishes throughout
- Existing mechanical systems left in place
- Phased over time instead of all at once

A note on phasing

Many of our clients spread a whole home renovation across two or three phases. This can make the project more manageable financially and operationally, though it usually costs slightly more in total than doing the work all at once. We help our clients think through the right approach for their situation.

LOCAL KNOWLEDGE

Planning a remodel in Eastern Pennsylvania

A few things about our region that affect planning, timelines and budget.

Permitting varies by township

Every township and borough in our service area handles permits a little differently, from Doylestown and Newtown in Bucks County to Easton and Forks Township in the Lehigh Valley. Some are quick. Some take weeks. We handle permitting on every project and factor the local timeline into the schedule.

Historic districts

Parts of Doylestown, New Hope, Easton and other older boroughs sit in historic districts with additional review requirements. This affects exterior changes more than interior remodels, but it is worth understanding early if your project includes windows, additions or facade changes.

Older homes

Across Bucks County, Montgomery County and the Lehigh Valley, many homes were built long before current wiring and plumbing codes. We are EPA Lead Safe certified, which matters for any home built before 1978. We plan for the realities of older construction rather than being surprised by them.

Seasonality

Spring and early summer are the busiest planning seasons. Booking the design and planning phase in late fall or winter often means a smoother build the following year.



PRACTICAL GUIDANCE

How to budget for your project

Five practical tips that consistently help our clients.

01

Build in a contingency

We recommend 10 to 15% of the project cost held aside for surprises. Older homes especially tend to reveal conditions during demolition that we cannot fully see beforehand.

02

Separate design and permits as line items

Design fees, engineering, permits and inspections are real costs that often get missed when homeowners estimate from a single number they saw online.

03

Plan for selection lead times

Custom cabinetry can run 12 to 16 weeks. Stone slabs, custom metalwork and specialty fixtures all have their own lead times. The planning phase is often longer than the build phase.

04

Get scope locked before pricing

A proposal based on rough scope will swing. A proposal based on a complete set of selections and a clear scope is the one to make decisions on.

05

Talk to more than one builder

We are not the right fit for every project. The homeowners who work with us are usually choosing between two or three builders. We encourage that, and we are happy to help you think through what to ask each one.

ABOUT US

A husband and wife owned remodeling company

Atlas Design & Build serves Bucks County, Montgomery County and the Lehigh Valley. We do custom bathroom remodeling, custom kitchen remodeling, basement remodeling and whole home renovations.

What sets us apart is how a project feels start to finish. Communication and organization are not extras. They are the core of how we work. Our clients know what is happening, when it is happening and what comes next, throughout the entire project.

OUR CREDENTIALS

- 20+ years of construction experience
- Project management certified
- Interior design certified
- EPA Lead Safe certified
- Custom metal and glass fabrication

OUR PROCESS

Discovery call → Site consultation → Design → Proposal and selections → Construction → Walkthrough and warranty

WHAT OUR CLIENTS SAY

> *"John and his team were top notch from start to finish. Their professionalism shined throughout the whole process. The attention to detail was second to none."*

> *"Atlas is very professional, reliable and extremely knowledgeable. The craftsmanship is top notch. They corrected small details I hadn't noticed to ensure everything was perfect."*

> *"John made the process stress free. They were courteous and timely and the final product was even better than we expected."*

LET'S TALK

Ready to talk through your project?

If you are planning a remodel and would like to walk through scope, budget and timeline with us, start with a short discovery call. From there we visit your home, listen to what you are trying to achieve and send you a written budget range within two business days.

SCHEDULE	atlasdesignandbuild.com/contact
CALL US	(484) 541-9818
EMAIL	info@atlasdesignandbuild.com

SERVICE AREA

Bucks County, Montgomery County and the Lehigh Valley, including Doylestown, Newtown, Yardley, Langhorne, Warrington, Chalfont, New Hope, Buckingham, Solebury, Easton and the surrounding towns.



ATLAS / DESIGN & BUILD

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Designed to impress.

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